

Independent verification

Positive

Some international agencies and experts have accepted Žerjavić's (and almost equal data achieved by Serbian statistician Bogoljub Kočović) calculations as the most reliable data on war losses in Yugoslavia during [World War II](#). A U.S. Census report from 1954 states: "Details of the (Yugoslav) 1948 census were kept secret but, in negotiations with Germany, it became apparent that the real figure of the dead was about one million. An American study in 1954 calculated 1,067,000."^[12]

Following Tito's death in 1980, the 1948 census results became available for comparison with those of 1931. Allowances had to be made for the birth rates of the different communities and for emigration. Research was pioneered by Professor Kočović, a Serb living in the West, whose findings were published in January 1985. He assessed the number of dead as 1,014,000. Later that year a [Serbian Academy of Sciences and Arts](#) Conference heard that the figure was 1,100,000.^[13]

Žerjavić's and Kočović's calculations of war losses in Yugoslavia during [World War II](#) were accepted by the [United States Holocaust Memorial Museum](#), together with other typically higher estimates:

Due to differing views and lack of documentation, estimates for the number of Serbian victims in Croatia range widely, from 25,000 to more than one million. The estimated number of Serbs killed in Jasenovac ranges from 25,000 to 700,000. The most reliable figures place the number of Serbs killed by the Ustaša between 330,000 and 390,000, with 45,000 to 52,000 Serbs murdered in Jasenovac.^[14]

Concerning Žerjavić's calculations on the number of casualties linked to the Bleiburg repatriations, historian [Ivo Goldstein](#) writes that it is "difficult to speak of the overall number" and that "the only option is to rely on the research by Vladimir Žerjavić, which has up to now shown itself to be the most reliable in overall estimates".^[3]

Negative

Some Serb critics of Žerjavić consider his work to have been politically motivated, with the aim of downplaying Croatian nationalist atrocities during the war, such as at Jasenovac.

Critics point out that Serbs in Bosnia and Croatia lived in rural areas and therefore had a much higher growth rate than others.^[clarification needed] Žerjavić used growth rates for Serbs in Bosnia as 1.1% (as for all nations together), while actual growth rate was 2.4% (1921–31) and 3.5% (1949–53). They posit he intentionally underestimated growth rate of Serbs to decrease the Serb death count, according to critics.^[citation needed] Some, like Đorđević, claimed that Serbian losses were in fact 1.6 million, a number which goes in other direction compared to the official estimates that Žerjavić denied. The higher numbers was opposed by Bogoljub Kočović's book, published in 1997, which tries to refute Đorđević's efforts to "reinstate" the "great numbers" victims figures dominant in Communist Yugoslavia.^[15]

The [Simon Wiesenthal Center](#) and [Yad Vashem](#) still use the old estimates given by the Yugoslav authorities.^[citation needed] The [Simon Wiesenthal Center](#) cites the Yad Vashem document, the [Encyclopedia of the Holocaust](#).^[16] In a separate entry on the Ustasha movement in general, however, Yad Vashem cites the extermination of "over 500,000" Serbs in the entire NDH.^[17]

Regarding Žerjavić's research on World War Two casualties, Croatian historian Vladimir Geiger notes that individual researchers who assert the inevitability of using identification of casualties and fatalities by individual names have raised serious objections to Žerjavić's

calculations/estimates of human losses by using standard statistical methods and consolidation of data from various sources, pointing out that such an approach is insufficient and unreliable in determining the number and character of casualties and fatalities, as well as the affiliation of the perpetrators of the crimes.^[18]

Žerjavić's calculations regarding the Bosnian war

According to Žerjavić's calculations, there were 215,000 victims in [Bosnia-Herzegovina](#) in the [Bosnian war](#) of 1992–95, of which 160,000 were [Bosniaks](#), 30,000 [Croats](#) and 25,000 [Serbs](#).^[19] However, according to newer research done by the International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia ([ICTY](#)), the number of people killed in the war in Bosnia-Herzegovina was around 102,000: 69.24% (70,625) Bosniaks, 25.35% (25,857) Serbs, and 5.33% (5,437) Croats.^[20]